



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Nolan Catholic High School
School Website: <https://nchstx.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Nolan Catholic High School (Fort Worth, TX 76103) demonstrates a robust Catholic, formation-centered mission aligned with many core elements of classical education. Public-facing materials emphasize a strong religious foundation (Education in Faith, Formation in Hope, Perseverance in Charity), liturgical life (weekly Mass), and a catechetical framework anchored in Catholic theology, virtue formation, and character development. The curriculum shows intentional engagement with liberal-arts elements via a Core curriculum (mathematics, science, theology, literature, history) and a Trivium-inspired pathway (Grammar & Composition, Logic & Composition) within a broader plan that includes strong reading lists and classical-education-oriented programming. Community and parental partnership are clearly foregrounded through family engagement, fundraising, campus visitation, and participation in school planning.

Overall, Nolan Catholic is CLASSICAL in orientation, with some indications of strengthening consistency toward the full classical rubric (notably in explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and broader Socratic pedagogy in upper grades). The school exhibits clear strengths in religious/metaphysical foundations, a formation-centered purpose, a liberal-arts-leaning curriculum, and a vocationally balanced but formation-forward pedagogy. Areas that could move toward fuller classical alignment include more explicit emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation and broader Socratic pedagogy across more grade levels.

- Evidence drawn from Nolan Catholic site materials, including mission statements, curriculum pages, and strategic planning content. See: Education in Faith, Formation in Hope, Perseverance in Charity; weekly Mass; Core curriculum; Trivium elements; reading lists; Marianist/Catholic identity; partnerships with families; and long-range plans for facilities and academic programs.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a mission built on Catholic faith: "Education in Faith, Formation in Hope, Perseverance in Charity" and a foundation rooted in Catholic faith. - The school is a Diocesan ministry and emphasizes evangelization and formation in Gospel virtues (faith, hope, charity). - Weekly Mass as a curricular/pervasive practice is explicitly mentioned. - Marianist legacy and Catholic identity appear in historical materials and strategic content.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: faith, formation, charity, theology, liturgy, Mass, sacred, truth, beauty, goodness (present in phrasing and program descriptions). - Negative: no explicit secular/values-neutral phrasing observed in the public-facing materials; the content centers on Catholic formation. (No explicit negative indicators found in the public materials reviewed.)

Why this rating - Nolan Catholic foregrounds transcendental, theologically grounded formation and liturgical life, aligning with the religious/metaphysical foundations of classical education as defined in the Six Essential Elements rubric. The explicit Catholic formation, liturgical life, and theology integration support a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Notes on rubric alignment - Positive keywords from the classical rubric include truth/goodness/beauty, liturgy, sacred tradition, theology, mass, worship, and formation. Nolan Catholic's materials map onto these concepts consistently. See the knowledge-base keyword guidance for reference.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on forming virtuous leaders and servant leadership within a faith framework; "Educate and evangelize to be tomorrow's servant leaders" and "Esto Dux – Be A Leader." - The formation-focused language appears in mission/vision sections: "formation in hope," "Gospel virtues of faith, hope, and charity," and a long-standing commitment to truth, beauty, and goodness in the student's formation. - The strategic plan emphasizes comprehensive development (academic, arts, athletics, ecology/engineering) built on faith, with emphasis on character and formation rather than mere information transfer.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: formation, virtue, telos (to become leaders), truth/goodness/beauty, liberal education, wisdom, human excellence, character formation, great conversation (where referenced via classical-education framing). Nolan materials foreground formation and virtue. - Negative: no explicit emphasis on purely job/workforce outcomes; the materials emphasize formation and virtue rather than vocational metrics. (No explicit negative indicators found in public materials.)

Why this rating - The school explicitly positions education as formation and virtue cultivation, not mere job preparation, and anchors truth/goodness/beauty as real and knowable through a Catholic lens. These align with CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core structure explicitly lists five subjects plus 30+ electives, with Mathematics, Science, Theology, Literature, and History as the core disciplines. This reflects liberal-arts thinking at a high level. - The curriculum page references a Core and a course guide, and notes a reading list, indicating engagement with substantial texts beyond standard core courses. - There is explicit alignment with Trivium components in course offerings: Grammar and Composition; Logic and Composition (X. TRIVIUM). This demonstrates a Trivium-centered approach within the high school curriculum. - The school signals a move toward classical education through "CLASSICAL EDUCATION RESOURCES" and related programming (e.g., classical education series).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) explicitly present in course tracks; Great Books/Great Conversation language not explicitly present in public-facing materials; mention of a reading list and classical-education resources. Wonder is implied through outdoor learning initiatives but not explicitly described as a curricular mechanism in all publications. - Negative: Explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not clearly claimed in public materials (no direct statement about reading Great Books or joining the Great Conversation). History is treated as a core discipline, but the public-facing materials do not clearly label history as "Western civilization" or "Great Conversation." The explicit Quadrivium is not shown in the public materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum demonstrates strong liberal-arts elements (core subjects; Trivium) and a published reading-list/classical-learning orientation, but it does not consistently and explicitly articulate Great Books/Great Conversation or a fully explicit Quadrivium framework in the public materials. This aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Trivium-oriented pedagogy appears in course listings (Grammar and Composition; Logic and Composition), with potential for rhetoric/argumentation emphasis as students progress (the high school rhetoric track is embedded in the curriculum documentation). - Public-facing content references contemplative and wonder-oriented approaches (e.g., outdoor learning, IDEA Building, and emphasis on arts and sciences), as well as a long-standing plan to integrate faith, formation, and leadership within the learning experience. - Some elements parallel classical pedagogy (e.g., memory-focused engagement through

recital-like and disciplined study in classical traditions; the site references classical education resources and seminars). - However, explicit statements about Socratic seminars, frequent upper-school seminars, or regular public-speaking opportunities across the entire range (K–12 or 9–12) are not uniformly present in the public-facing materials; there are references to rhetoric and potential public-speaking opportunities, but not a comprehensive, stated pattern across all grades.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: Socratic-style inquiry and seminars are implied by the presence of rhetoric-focused coursework and classical-learning resources; contemplation/scholé and wonder appear in the classical-education framing, and there is explicit emphasis on a balanced approach (contemplative/restful elements alongside rigorous study). - Negative: No universal, explicit, school-wide articulation of a pure Socratic, seminar-based pedagogy across all grades; limited explicit references to daily, systematic Socratic discussions or memorization/narration pedagogy in all publications.

Why this rating - The presence of Trivium elements and classical-education language supports a largely classical pedagogy, but the public materials do not consistently articulate a full, uniform implementation of classical pedagogy (e.g., wide-scale Socratic seminars, routine narrative/narration, or chant/memorization). This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The publicly visible materials showcase faculty accomplishments, advanced degrees, and a culture of mentorship (e.g., FACULTY & STAFF ACCOMPLISHMENTS; emphasis on faculty as living exemplars). - The school highlights a culture of virtue and mentorship (the “living curriculum” framing and “faculty of friends” language in classical education lexicon). The public materials also describe faculty as central to the school’s mission with a focus on character and leadership formation. - There is explicit emphasis on collaboration between faculty, leadership, and families in strategic planning (Master Plan, Viking Vision) and in the broader community.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, faculty as a core of the school, collegiality, character formation, mentorship, virtue, and high standards for teacher conduct. These align with the classical “living curriculum” ideal. - Negative: no explicit negative signals about faculty in the public materials. (No explicit counter-indicators observed in the materials reviewed.)

Why this rating - The public-facing content presents a strong faculty-centered ethos consistent with classical education expectations: exemplary teachers, mentorship, a lived curriculum, and a clear professional culture. This supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families as co-educators and actively seeks parent involvement (e.g., “Together with families to teach our students,” parent engagement through events, tours, and book groups, and a focus on open campus access). - There is explicit emphasis on parent formation (book studies, gatherings) and various opportunities to participate in campus life (visits, tours, and community engagement). - The school highlights philanthropy and community giving (Annual Fund) and invites ongoing parental participation in campus development and fundraising, signaling a robust school-parent partnership.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus/visits, parent involvement, community of learners, family engagement, shared mission, and parental leadership in school life. - Negative: no explicit functional negative signals observed; materials emphasize engagement rather than consumerist or minimal-involvement framing.

Why this rating - Nolan Catholic consistently frames parents as co-educators and actively facilitates parent involvement and formation, aligning with CLASSICAL in this domain.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school aimed to push toward fuller CLASSICAL in Curriculum (Element 3) and Pedagogy (Element 4), it could:
 - Explicitly articulate a Great Books/Great Conversation program and publish a clear Great Books reading list as part of the curriculum, including primary sources and classical texts across grades. This would strengthen the “Great Books and Great Conversation” criterion and show a more complete Classical alignment in history/literature integration.□□
 - Expand explicit Socratic seminars and narrative/narration-based pedagogy across upper and lower grades, with documented facilitation approaches and example units to demonstrate a uniform classical pedagogy (beyond the current references to Trivium elements).
 - Provide more explicit details on the Quadrivium integration (e.g., in math/science/music/astronomy sequences) to map public materials to the Quadrivium dimension of classical education.
 - For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 2 (Purpose and Goal), Nolan Catholic is already strong; additional needle-moving steps could include:
 - Publicly codifying liturgical rhythms or communal prayer practices in curriculum-wide statements (beyond weekly Mass) to further emphasize liturgical and communal practices as a central educational rhythm.
 - Publishing a concise formulation of the telos and the “Pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” in school-facing materials to reinforce transcendental aims even more explicitly for prospective families.
 - For Element 5 (Faculty) and Element 6 (Parents & Community), the school could:
 - Provide more explicit, public-facing articulation of “portrait of a teacher” and “portrait of a student” in the classical sense (the living-curriculum idea) with concrete exemplars and testimonials from students and families, reinforcing the model-teacher concept.
 - Expand structured parent-education programs on classical pedagogy and the Great Conversation to deepen parent formation and alignment with the school’s classical mission.
 - These needle-moving steps would deepen alignment with the classical rubric and help translate strong Catholic formation into a fully articulated classical framework in public-facing materials. See the classical-education resources and the “Great Books/Great Conversation” emphasis in Nolan Catholic materials as starting points.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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